

## How to connect to an EC2 instance when we lost the key pair

Steps:

1. Stop the instance
2. Detach its root EBS volume
3. Attach that volume to another EC2 instance (as a secondary volume)
4. SSH into the helper instance
5. Mount the volume and edit the `authorized_keys` file:

```
sudo mkdir /mnt/recovery
sudo mount /dev/xvdf1 /mnt/recovery # device name may differ
```

```
sudo nano /mnt/recovery/home/ubuntu/.ssh/authorized_keys
```

6. Paste your **new public key** into the file
7. Save, unmount:

```
sudo umount /mnt/recovery
```

8. Detach volume and reattach to the original instance
9. Start the instance and SSH using your new private key.

### ✗ What you CANNOT do

- You cannot recover or download the old private key from AWS
- AWS does not store private keys for security reasons